

STAGE TWELVE • LEADERSHIP

FIRSTS

Leadership

SESSION 1

Leadership Foundations

FIRSTS P1-P10

Leadership Awareness

- Earned through trust, not granted by title
- Authority $\neq$ genuine leadership
- Foundation for the whole stage

Leadership Style Assessment

- Strengths and blind spots, both
- Self-perception alone often misses the blind spots
- Check it against how others experience you

Leadership Responsibility

- Genuine ownership, not just effort
- Accountable even when it doesn't go perfectly
- Required before anyone trusts you with more

Leadership Role

- Observation and responsibility aren't enough alone
- Real experience only comes from actually holding one
- Don't wait to feel fully ready

Meeting Led

- Leading a meeting is a distinct, learnable skill
- An unused agenda helps no one
- Always close with explicit next steps

Team Goal Set

- A team without a clear goal drifts
- Never assume it's obvious from context
- Confirm everyone can restate it themselves

Vision Communicated

- A vision motivates; a task list just directs
- Compliance vs. genuine engagement
- Explain why it matters, not just what to do

Task Delegation

- Genuine fit beats convenience
- Develops people, not just distributes work
- Don't always default to who's already comfortable

Accountability System Created

- Commitments quietly slip without tracking
- A system alone isn't enough — review it
- Real visibility into what's on track

Leadership Decision Made

- Weight beyond your own individual choices
- Delay often costs more than an imperfect call
- Communicate the reasoning, not just the decision

SESSION 2

Leading & Developing People

FIRSTS P11-P20

Difficult Decision Made

- Easy decisions don't build real judgment
- Don't pretend a hard call was obvious
- Uncertainty is where leadership actually develops

Leadership Communication

- Unclear expectations breed real friction
- Said once $\neq$ understood
- Confirm explicitly, every time

Team Motivation Exercise

- Not a single speech at kickoff
- Ongoing attention through the hard stretches
- Specific action beats generic encouragement

Person Mentored

- Distinct from doing the work yourself
- Multiplies impact by building real capability
- A sustained relationship, not one conversation

Person Coached

- Questions, not answers
- Builds genuine independent problem-solving
- Resist the urge to just tell them

Constructive Feedback Given as a Leader

- Carries particular weight from a leader
- Too soft loses the point; too blunt discourages
- Improvement and motivation, both

Difficult Feedback Conversation

- Avoidance usually makes it worse
- Erodes trust in your leadership over time
- Prepare specifically what you'll say

Conflict Handled as a Leader

- Not optional — a core responsibility
- Unresolved conflict undermines real delivery
- Hoping it resolves itself rarely works

Team Performance Review

- Honest evaluation lets you course-correct early
- Waiting until the end leaves no time to fix it
- Compare against the real, original goal

Leadership Presentation

- Your judgment is being evaluated too
- Excessive hedging undermines confidence
- Own the recommendation clearly

SESSION 3

Advanced & Reflective Leadership

FIRSTS P21-P30

Cross-Functional Leadership Experience

- Different disciplines, different vocabularies
- Leading it like your own function misses the work
- Genuine translation is the actual skill

Leadership Without Authority

- Most real influence has no formal power behind it
- Demands and pressure backfire without authority
- Frame requests around a shared goal

Stakeholder Influence Exercise

- One pitch for everyone rarely works
- Understand what each stakeholder actually cares about
- Tailor the framing, not just the delivery

Crisis Leadership Exercise

- Calm and direction shape the team's own response
- Freezing or panicking both spread the wrong signal
- How you show up matters as much as what you decide

Leadership Under Pressure

- Sustained pressure tests differently than one crisis
- Judgment can erode slowly, not just snap
- Composure over the long stretch, not just the moment

Strategic Leadership Exercise

- Managing tasks well isn't the same as strategic
- Risk: leading efficiently toward the wrong destination
- Step back and connect the dots regularly

Leadership Feedback Received

- People hesitate to critique authority
- Silence isn't the same as things going well
- Actively, genuinely seek it out

Leadership Mistake Reflection

- Every leader makes real mistakes
- Growth comes from honest analysis, not deflection
- Own your specific role in what happened

Leadership Philosophy

- Consistency over reacting to mood or circumstance
- Grounded in real experience, not aspiration
- Two to three sentences, genuinely yours

Leadership Development Plan

- Turns growth into a genuine, trackable practice
- Fewer priorities, genuinely pursued
- Closes the stage — into real next steps

Stage Twelve, Complete

One milestone, named out loud, from your development plan.